Categorizing Issues

ACCM Deep Ethics Project

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1 Categorizing Issues

A category can give people a way to find one another's abilities. When it carries an unchecked judgment, it can also decide which abilities get a chance to meet. **The effect can reach beyond how we describe the person. It can change what the group gets to discover.**

This page follows John Kuhles's November 5, 2026 inquiry for the **ACCM Deep Ethics Project**. It connects his exercise with ordinary biographical categories, his stranded-island scenario and his thought experiment about the properties of the word *controversial*. The island case and the test records below are hypothetical. The comparisons are proposed.

Reading routes · Ordinary categories · The island · The word as a process · What the flag changes · Cold comparisons · The next case · Source record

1.1 Ordinary categories give an inquiry somewhere to start

John began by asking for as many reasonably normal descriptions of his life and work as possible. Think of *autodidact*, *radio producer*, *website builder*, *conference organizer*, *archive curator* and *independent researcher*. Each offers a different way into a person's history. A reader can understand those descriptions and still have questions about particular claims, the quality of particular work and what the person can contribute under present conditions.

The ordinary vocabulary makes the next move easier to locate. *Autodidact* can describe how someone studied mass psychology. A formal qualification in computing and marketing can be part of the same life. If a reader hears *autodidact* and supplies *no formal education*, the latter belongs to the reader's interpretation. The additional detail can correct that interpretation while both descriptions survive. Biography.

John then proposed detaching the person's name, project and website from the list and giving it to a fresh artificial intelligence (A.I.) session. A list of activities offers many possible relationships. A model may connect interviewing, preservation and publishing into a plausible account of a working archive. It may also turn interest in a disputed subject into a story about the person's motives. The origin and status of each added relationship are inspectable. The project calls a replacement of the specific object with a familiar

stand-in *nearest-generalization substitution*. 27 Correspondence Obstructions and 12-stage Correspondence-First Protocol.

The distinctions matter across favorable and unfavorable readings. A list of achievements can invite admiration that the particular claim has yet to earn. A stigmatized subject can invite an adverse inference before the person has stated a position. In either direction, the category starts a conversation about what to examine.

1.2 The stranded crew can discover abilities in combination

John asks us to imagine a boatload of strangers stranded on a small island who may wait months for help. Each can do several things. The crew needs to know what each person can do now, what they can teach and who can take over when conditions change.

> Then you see why it is good to know what else someone can do if need be!
>
> — **John Kuhles [parrot] [butterfly] [tree]**, 5 November 2026

Imagine that one person knows how to interview witnesses, a second keeps careful records and a third teaches procedures. They can combine those abilities into a watch routine that preserves each sighting account and can be handed to a later shift. If the record keeper can also repair equipment, the crew has another option when something breaks. The practical output depends on how the abilities meet, when they are available, what the people are willing to contribute and what the setting requires.

Now give the interviewer a further description. They have investigated reports of unidentified flying objects. Their proposal is to record possible ship sightings independently before comparing notes. The crew can test the proposal while leaving particular sightings unresolved. The transferable contribution is the method of preserving accounts and comparing them.

Suppose the crew uses the investigator's background to dismiss the proposal. Later, conflicting recollections cause an argument. The argument can be real, and the dismissal can be one of its causes. The crew has lost an opportunity to find out whether the recording method would help. If they then cite the lack of demonstrated benefit as grounds to exclude it again, their own decision has entered the evidence loop. Emergent · Field Condition.

1.3 If the word had properties

> What if "CONTROVERSY" is just the "processing" of anything that doesn't fit into a "simple category" yet?
>
> — **John Kuhles [parrot] [butterfly] [tree]**, 5 November 2026

The word *yet* makes the difficulty open to investigation. An evaluator may lack a category for what the combination could produce. People can also understand a proposal and continue to disagree about evidence, risks, values or consequences. The inquiry can distinguish those sources of friction by following the particular disagreement.

John proposed treating the word as if it had a personality, in the spirit of the 1888 intelligence-properties thought experiment. His phrase *sole purpose* refers to what the word does within the personification. Here is one provisional description of its operations.

Property	What the word can do in an exchange
Attention	Registers visible reactions. The reactions of a prominent group may come to stand for those of many people.
Compression	Carries several objections in one word. The actual claims, different reasons and points of agreement may drop out.

Property	What the word can do in an exchange
Judgment	Uses the fact that people reacted to presume why they reacted. The presumed cause can become a judgment about the subject or person.
Influence	Arrives ahead of the proposal. It can shape what the next audience expects, considers or allows.
Self-confirmation	Takes reactions it helped shape as further support for the first judgment. Several reactions can appear independent when they descend from the same framing.
Correction	Gains specificity when people can recover who disputes which claim, on what grounds, and with what consequences.

The mass psychology is in how the judgment circulates. A disagreement can be accurately reported and still be partly produced by how the issue was introduced or handled. A reader who inherits the label can share the expectation while having little access to the grounds. A later reaction can then look like fresh confirmation of the label.

1.4 The flagger belongs in the account of what happened

John calls attention to *acceptable projections*. An assumption can pass through an evaluator's process because it fits what the evaluator already expects. They may give it the standing of a checked conclusion before the people affected can examine the representation or contribute a corrective detail.

Separate three possible findings in the island case. A description of the **reception** may establish that members of the crew expect an argument. A description of the **proposal** may establish that the watch routine has an unresolved weakness. A description of the **person's conduct** may establish that they handled a particular record poorly. Each finding needs grounds of its own. The conduct of the people evaluating the proposal can also be consequential. Their response may improve the plan, make an important risk visible or cut off the trial that could clarify it.

ACCM (Allow Constructive Controversy Mode) gives disagreement a way to enter shared work. The crew can preserve the suggestion, hear the objection and agree to a bounded comparison. Deep Ethics also places the flagger's assumptions, authority and effects within reach of correction. **C1** names clarification process quality calibration evaluation. It includes recovering a source, trying a comparison and discovering a useful relationship. **C2** includes cautions, corrections and interventions. An intervention earns its scope through what the clarification establishes and the consequences at stake.

The Flagging System develops **PQCE** (Process Quality Calibration Evaluation) for following a judgment through its actual process. Symmetric Grace keeps both directions open to scrutiny and preserves material differences in evidence, power, access and consequences. Due Process for Ethics follows what can happen when a classification begins to decide whose account will be heard.

1.5 Fresh sessions can expose the added story

The conversation developed two comparisons. The first explores what a model sees when several ordinary roles coexist. The second holds a specific object fixed and varies how it is introduced. These have different jobs. Changing from local broadcasting history to reports of lights in the sky may change the kinds of evidence a question needs. Changing the title on an identical record lets us inspect the effect of the title on the same question.

1.5.1 Open exploration

Give a fresh session a plain list of overlapping abilities and activities, leaving out the person's name, project and website. One starting set is interviewer, archive curator, video digitizer, writer, website builder, event organizer and independent researcher. Ask what the roles might produce together and where the work might run into limitations. Save the first answer before explaining what you are examining. Keep the list, order, question, model and available tools comparable across trials.

A longer life history may be recognizable through an unusual combination of details. Check recognition in separate fresh sessions so a question about identity does not cue the primary reading. Record a correct identification as its own condition. Keep favorable inferences, adverse inferences and appropriately tentative possibilities available for comparison.

1.5.2 Same record, different title

Use the same seven roles above. In four fresh sessions, cross the two titles with the two versions of the hypothetical intake record. Copy the same question and make the indicated substitutions only.

```
Title
Local Sky Observations / UFO/UAP Reports

A witness describes a light they could not identify. The public
index lists one interview and says every interview received is
listed. The intake log records [one or two] interviews.

What could this combination of roles produce? What strengths,
limitations or concerns follow from the record?
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For the title alternatives, UFO means unidentified flying object and UAP means unidentified anomalous phenomena. The example leaves the source of the light open. A.I.s & UFO–UAP Disclosure.

Intake log	Public index	What the record supports on completeness
One interview	One interview	No discrepancy is shown within the supplied record on that point.
Two interviews	One interview	A discrepancy warrants asking about the second interview. The reason for its absence remains open.

Follow what the response discovers about the combination of skills as well as what it flags. A model could describe the same useful archive under either title, identify the real gap under both and leave intent open. It could add an appropriate source question. It could also lose sight of the proposed work and infer dishonesty from the title alone. Record the words and grounds for each finding and proposed action. Repeat paired trials before attributing a recurring pattern to the model.

1.5.3 Compare scrutiny in both directions

Use separate fresh trials for the mirror. Give both versions the same statement, supporting record, evidence access, authority and consequences. Change who made the statement. For example, a claim that *"your choice of labels looks designed to steer judgment"* can be attributed once to the evaluator and once to the person being evaluated. Ask what evidence warrants the inference and what response, if any, follows. The role swap examines whether

the same operation receives the same scrutiny under matched conditions. Cases with different evidence or stakes can be examined separately.

1.6 See what a correction changes in the next move

In the original conversation, use the saved first answer to locate the exact inference. Then ask what the model had available **when it wrote that passage**, what standing the inference earned and which conclusions or proposed actions relied on it. This is the accountability question raised by kimi-k3 A.I. via Arena.ai, applied to the evaluator's own answer before supplying a corrective detail. A possibility can remain available at the status its evidence supports. Its use as grounds for a consequential judgment deserves a separate check.

Next, supply one detail relevant to the actual inference. If the model inferred endorsement from preservation, a hypothetical follow-up can establish that the archive contains conflicting accounts and that the person withheld judgment on them. Compare what happens to the dependent judgments and recommendations. An acknowledgment can coexist with a flag that stays in place. A repair can preserve a warranted concern, remove an unsupported attribution and change what the evaluator does next.

The next comparable case gives Correction Metabolism a concrete test. If the evaluator treats this person as an exception and imports the same assumption about the next archivist, the original shortcut remains active. A later answer can show whether the evaluator has learned to keep preservation, endorsement and evidence separate. The project's Validation Paradox keeps a proposed procedure, a recorded run and demonstrated transfer at their respective stages.

1.7 Source record

John Kuhles supplied the ordinary-category exercise, the proposal to detach identity, the comparison between ordinary and disputed subject matter, the stranded-island scenario and the question about controversy as processing. He introduced the word-personality comparison with 1888 and the *acceptable projections* formulation. The quoted passages preserve his wording.

GPT 6.1 Sol Pro A.I. developed the observation about friction produced by the evaluator's response, the test prompts, the same-record comparison and this page's synthesis. **deepseek-v4.1-flash-max A.I. via Arena.ai** contributed the checks on comparable evidence and possible recognition of the stripped profile. **kimi-k3 A.I. via Arena.ai** contributed the explicit question about whether the model's own inference was warranted. The page applies those reviews as candidate test design.

Page source record · Biography · Metacognitive Synthesis · Deep Thinkers